

Welcome!

We'll get started shortly. Please take the Zoom poll in the meanwhile!

CS 49 Week 8

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How to get hold of me / get help from other resources

- Surajit's office hours
 - Fridays 12 noon–1p, directly after section
 - By appointment on [Zoom](#)
 - Post on the [section forum](#), usually get a response within 2 hours
 - Email bosesurajit@fhda.edu or Canvas inbox, 24 hr turnaround
 - The [github repo](#) has section materials, starter code, and solutions
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- Canvas inbox for Lane
- The [main forum](#) for the course on the Code in Place site
- [Lane's office hours](#)
- [Online](#) or [in-person](#) tutoring (Room 3600)
- [One-on-one code reviews](#) with Sarah or Lia

Agenda

- Goal: To understand and learn to use lists in Python
- Types
 - Atomic vs Container
 - Mutable vs Immutable
- Lists
 - Creating lists
 - Accessing list elements
 - Useful list methods
- Section Problem: [Fruit List](#)

Types of Python types

Atomic and Container Types (Slide 1 of 2)

- In Python, **int**, **float**, **Boolean**, or **None** are all **atomic** types
- A value of those types is a single value
- Python also has **container** types
- Containers are what they sound like
 - They can be empty, or they can hold any number of values
 - They are **collections** of elements
 - We can access individual elements in the container
 - We can **iterate** (loop) over all the elements in a container
- Surprise! We've been working with one container type already
 - Any guesses as to what?

Atomic and Container Types (Slide 2 of 2)

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- Surprise! We've been working with one container type already
 - **str**

Mutable vs Immutable Types (Slide 1 of 2)

- All the types we've been looking at so far have been **immutable**
- By definition, immutable objects cannot be changed in memory; they can only be replaced with a different object
- All atomic types are immutable
- Strings are immutable:

```
hi = 'Hello'
```

creates a string in memory

and assigns it to the variable hi

```
hi = 'Hello there'
```

does not modify the original string

in memory; creates a new string

and assigns it to the variable hi

Mutable vs Immutable Types (Slide 2 of 2)

- Python has several **mutable** container types
- These containers can be changed in memory without being replaced
- We can add elements to or remove elements from the container
- One useful mutable container type is **list**
- As with **str**:
 - A **list** can be empty or arbitrarily large
 - We can iterate over their elements of a **list**
- Unlike **str**:
 - We can mutate a **list**
 - Elements in a **list** do not all have to be the same type

Lists

Creating a list

- A new, empty list can be created with a pair of square brackets:

```
my_list = []
```

- A new list can also be created with elements in it:

```
colors = ['red', 'blue']
```

- List elements are separated by commas
- Another way to create a new list is by adding two lists together:

```
more_colors = ['green', 'yellow']
```

```
colors_two = colors + more_colors
```

```
# colors_two is ['red', 'blue', 'green', 'yellow']
```

```
# Original lists colors, more_colors are unchanged
```

Accessing list elements (Slide 1 of 2)

- An element's position in the list is its index
- Indices start at zero and go up to one less than the number of elements
- E.g., given **colors_two** = **['red', 'blue', 'green', 'yellow']**
 - **'red'** is at index 0
 - **'blue'** at index 1
 - **'green'** at index 2
 - **'yellow'** at index 3
- Access an element with the index in square brackets after the list name
shrek_color = colors_two[2] *# shrek_color is 'green'*

Accessing list elements (Slide 2 of 2)

- We can also use negative indices, with index of the last element being -1
- E.g., given `colors_two = ['red', 'blue', 'green', 'yellow']`
 - `'yellow'` is at index -1
 - `'green'` at index -2
 - `'blue'` at index -3
 - `'red'` at index -4
- Access an element with the index in square brackets after the list name
`gumby_color = colors_two[-3]` # *gumby_color is 'blue'*

Useful list methods (Slide 1 of 2)

- Given `numbers = [79, 84, 20, 5]`
- We can print the entire list:
`print(numbers)`
- We can iterate over a list in a for-each loop:
`for number in numbers:`
`print(f"Current number is: {}")`
- We can add to the end of the list
`numbers.append(13)` *# list is now [79, 84, 20, 5, 13]*
- We can get the length of the list
`how_many = len(numbers)` *# how_many is 5*
- Worked example: [Index Game](#).

Useful list methods (Slide 2 of 2)

- Given `numbers = [79, 84, 20, 5, 13]`
- We can check whether a particular number is in the list:
`18 in numbers` *# True if 18 is in the list, else False*
- We can get the index of a particular element:
`my_ind = numbers.index(84)` *# my_ind is 1*
- We can remove from the end of the list
`my_num = numbers.pop()` *# list is now [79, 84, 20, 5]*
 # my_num is 13
- We can total the list elements:
`total = sum(numbers)` *# total is 188*

Section Problem: Fruit List

Section Problem: Fruit List

- Create a list of these fruits: apple, banana, orange, grape, pineapple
- Print the length of the created list
- Add mango to the end of the list
- Print the updated list. Try two different approaches:
 - Print the entire list on one line
 - Print each fruit on its own line

That's all, folks!

Next up: Dictionaries!

Bonus Slides

File I/O

Accessing data from files (Slide 1 of 3)

- Python can read and write plain text files
- Usually these have the filename extension **.txt**
- **.py**, **.html**, **.cpp**, or other source code files are also typically plain text
- Sometimes plain text files lack an extension altogether
- Notepad, TextEdit, BBEdit, and other text editors can create plain text files
- Microsoft Word and other word processors can export files as plain text
- Opening a text file in Python can be a security risk
- Open only files from a trusted and verified source!
 - Anyone can send a file purporting to be from your boss, your bank, your family member ...

Accessing data from files (Slide 2 of 3)

- To open a file for reading or writing, use the **with open** statement:
with open (*path/to/file*, *mode*) **as fh**:
indented block to read or write the file
- **fh** is whatever variable name you want to use for the file
 - **fh** is common, as it's short for **file handle**
 - **infile** is also common for files to be read
 - **outfile** is also common for files to be written
- *path/to/file* is a **str** specifying the location of the file on the system
 - The path can be [relative or absolute](#)
 - It is often a constant or received as input from the user

Accessing data from files (Slide 3 of 3)

- To open a file for reading or writing, use the **with open** statement:

```
with open (path/to/file, mode) as fh:
```

```
    # indented block to read or write the file
```

- *mode* is a **str** specifying one of three options:
 - **'r'** for read. This is the default and can be omitted
 - **'w'** for write
 - If the file does not exist, it will be created
 - Watch out! If the file already exists, it will be overwritten!
 - **'a'** for append
 - If the file exists, the new data will be added to the end
 - If the file does not exist, it will be created

Reading from a file

- Python reads the file one line at a time, each line as a **str**
- It's usually efficient to loop over all the lines and add them to a list
- Each element of the list is one line of the file as a **str**
- Sample code:

```
lines = []  
with open ('file_to_read.txt', 'r') as infile:  
    for line in infile:  
        lines.append(line.strip())
```

- **strip()** removes whitespace from the beginning and end of the lines, such as tabs `'\t'` or newlines `'\n'`

Writing to a file

- Python can write strings out to a file
- Remember that the `'w'` option will overwrite the file if it exists!
- Say you have a list of names: `['Jane', 'John', 'June', 'Joe']`
- The following code will write the names out to the file, one name per line:

```
with open ('file_to_write.txt', 'w') as outfile:
```

```
    for name in names:
```

```
        outfile.write(f'{name}\n')
```

```
        # or outfile.write(name + '\n')
```

- Note that unlike `print()`, you must explicitly supply `'\n'` to `write()`